

1950, March 20

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the
Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

SAINT FELIX FRIARY
HUNTINGTON, INDIANA†

FEAST OF ST† JOSEPH.
1950 A.D.
This Year, March 20th.

Mr. Patrick Casey . Seattle, Washington.

My Dear Brother Patrick; -

God bless you these unsettled days; you and yours. Many thanks for your kind favor of March 12th as also that of a few weeks back, as well as the letter you sent me before Christmas. I am really ashamed of myself not to have answered or acknowledged any of these before. I did start to do so a number of times.

In fact its been on my mind to write you ever since the beautiful death of poor, dear Father Maurice Joachim; who as you know passed from time into eternity on the fifth anniversary of our dear eldest Brother James, January 12th, a year ago, (1949) and by happy coincidence we buried him on the fifty second anniversary of my own receiving of the holy Habit. Glory be to God! I hardly thought of it at the time or realized the beauty or the delicacy of the connection in each case, especially my own - the one five years apart, the other, ten times five plus. The more I think it over the better I appreciate it. Deo Gratias.

I know you have quite some details of that death - that happy transition I hope - from Father Edward - Rt. Rev. Monsignor rather. But new details of anyone we've loved are always welcome and, since he and myself, of all the family and Clan were the only ones present, I feel I owe at least some such particulars. I probably ought to go into quite some more features of so interesting an event but I am a slow writer - only learning to type - and there are so many other things I ought to be doing.

Well to start with; we received a wire from Father Edward Wednesday morning, inside of an hour after M.J.'s passing: "Father Maurice Joachim died the morning at 6:20." Expecting further details and presuming that the funeral would be on Saturday and possibly in St. Paul or Prescott, Wis., I waited till next morning, although when I reached the very Rev. Father Provincial "long distance" at noon same day, in N.Y. he told me without hesitation to go to the Funeral. Of course, you remember Father M.J. had been with us almost ten years before that fearful carbuncle knocked him so completely out.